Riansares 4R — old homes: sound and safe rehabilitation

Is it advisable to remove partitions in an old house?

Not without identifying each element’s function and the consequences for services, stability, permits and waste. First inspect and document the structure and substrate condition; consider retaining the layout if it meets needs. A competent technical professional must be involved in creating openings or modifying structural elements.

How is renovation planned around old timber and walls?

Separate maintenance, defects, services and finishes. Check beams, bearings, damp, biological attack and loads where appropriate; do not cover damaged elements merely to hide them. Maintain material compatibility, ventilation and drying capacity. Seek structural assessment for significant deflection, cracks or deformation.

When does selective demolition make sense?

When finishes are damaged but other elements can be retained. Before breaking out, locate services, check hazards and define what will be removed, what will be protected and how waste will be managed. Trial openings can reduce uncertainty without destroying sound areas.

What risks arise in an old home left closed for years?

There may be undetected leaks, damp, obsolete services, condensation, crumbling substrates, pests and inadequate ventilation. The initial inspection prioritises safety, water, electricity, structure, roofing and drainage, rather than choosing finishes first.

What if suspicious materials appear during demolition?

Stop the affected work and consult an authorised professional to identify risks and manage hazardous materials under Spanish regulations. As a foreign technical reference, the UK HSE explains the importance of identifying concealed asbestos-containing materials before intrusive work: HSE asbestos survey. British obligations do not replace Spanish ones.

Hypothetical case V-01 — Rural home with cracks and damp walls

Fictional example. The owner wants tiling and painting. Before choosing materials, cracks are documented, possible movement and water entry are checked, and structural assessment is referred to a specialist where appropriate. Do not promise permanent waterproofing through painting or cladding.

Hypothetical case V-02 — House occupied during renovation

Fictional example. Access routes, service interruptions, cleaning, protection of occupied areas and bathroom/kitchen phases are planned. NAHB recommends advance communication and preparation for service interruptions.